



(Don't Write anything in this Area)

- (c) Briefly discuss the characteristics of Food Producing Societies with appropriate examples. (15 marks)

Food Producing Societies are those societies which produce their own food such as pastoral societies, horticultural societies and agricultural societies.

Characteristics

① Nature of living :

- 1.1) Pastoralists have nomadic or semi-nomadic way of living Eg. Gaddis
- 1.2) Societies that practice swiddening or jhum cultivation have semi-nomadic way of living.
Eg. Garos, Khasis
- 1.3) Agricultural societies have sedentary way of living.

② Population density:

2.1) Pastoral and horticultural societies have moderate to low population densities.

2.2) Agricultural societies have higher population densities.

③ Political organisation:

3.1) Pastoral and horticultural societies are organised in bands or tribes

Eg. Lambadas are organised into 'thandas'

3.2) Agricultural societies have a more centralised leadership.

④ Economic organisation:

4.1) Redistribution economy can be seen in these societies.

4.2) In advanced agricultural societies there is market economy.

⑤ Production and consumption:

5.1) In food producing societies, there is production of surplus food. The surplus food is either sold or stored.

5.2) The consumption is both immediate and for the future.

⑥ Division of labour:

6.1) There is a sexual division of labour in food producing economies.

6.2) However, the status of women falls from pastoral societies to horticultural societies.

Thus, the above are the characteristics of food producing economies. They later evolve into industrial societies like the contemporary societies.